

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-I

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are TWENTY questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-10 carry 10 marks each and should be answered in 150 words.
3. Questions 11-20 carry 15 marks each and should be answered in 250 words.
4. Answers must remain relevant to the demand and use appropriate examples.

Q1. Explain how wave refraction and differential erosion produce the headland-bay coastal pattern.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q2. Classify islands by origin and explain why present shape alone is inadequate.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q3. Explain why industrial location cannot be reduced to raw-material proximity.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q4. Explain why separate residence in urban India does not by itself prove the decline of the joint family.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q5. Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q6. Why did Curzon's policies accelerate militant nationalism?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Why did the Khilafat issue give Gandhi a workable platform for Hindu-Muslim unity in 1920?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Distinguish non-alignment from neutrality with reference to India's foreign policy between 1947 and 1961.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q9. Why should Indo-Islamic architecture be read through coexistence of trabeate and arcuate systems rather than through a clean civilisational break?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q10. Distinguish the Concert of Europe from the Holy Alliance.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q11. Assess India's Himalayan temperate forests as the subcontinental parallel of the cool temperate western-margin biome.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q12. Assess the Himalayan altitudinal zonation as India's analogue of the Siberian boreal belt.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q13. Explain the distribution of offshore petroleum reserves and how it differs from onshore occurrence.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q14. Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary?

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q15. Examine why the quality of rehabilitation, rather than the fact of displacement, determines tribal development outcomes.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q16. How did overseas networks transform Indian revolutionary politics before and during the First World War?

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q17. Assess the Swarajist experiment in the legislatures between 1923 and the later 1920s.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q18. Assess India's official-language settlement between 1959 and 1967, distinguishing the constitutional position from the statutory and political settlement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q19. Khajuraho should be read as a complete sacred landscape, not as a shorthand for erotic sculpture. Discuss.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q20. How far did alliances cause the First World War?

[15 marks | 250 words]

END OF PAPER